ANQI HU

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EMPLOYMENT

Postdoctoral Fellow January 2025 – December 2027
University of Western Ontario, Psychology
Supervisor: Dr. Ryan Stevenson

Research Associate September 2024 – December 2024
Northeastern University,
Supervisor: Dr. Zhenghan Qi

Strategy, Evaluation, and Analysis Intern September 2023 – April 2024
Patient-Centered Outcomes Research Institute (PCORI),
Department: Strategy, Evaluation, and Analysis

EDUCATION

PhD University of Delaware, Linguistics and Cognitive Science August 2024
Advisor: Zhenghan Qi

MA University of Delaware, Linguistics and Cognitive Science May 2021

BA University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, Linguistics May 2018
Graduated Summa Cum Laude
Queen Mary University of London (exchange student)
Minored in Speech and Hearing Sciences,
Teaching English as a Second Language

HONORS AND AWARDS

Western Postdoctoral Fellowship 2025 - 2027
Total fellowship of $148,681 CAD, complemented by $10,000 research funding

Unidel Distinguished Graduate Scholar Competitive Fellowship 2018 - 2024
Total fellowship of $170,000 USD, complemented by $18,000 research funding

Society for Language Development Student Award 2022
One of two winners for the year, awarded SLD membership and $150 USD

Gorilla Experiment Builder Grant (Spotlight Interview) 2020

One hundred experiment participant tokens

College of Arts and Sciences Graduate Student Travel Awards 2019
Granted $1,395 USD for training in hyperscanning studies at the State Key Laboratory of Cognitive Neuroscience, Beijing Normal University

Outstanding Undergraduate Student in Linguistics 2018

Dean's List 2014 - 2018

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Publications

Ovans Z., Ayala A., Asmah R., Hu A., Montoute M., Van Horne A., Qi Z., Morini G., & Huang Y.T. (2025). The feasibility of online (virtual-world) eye-tracking with young children. *Open Mind*. 9: 992-1019. DOI: doi.org/10.1162/opmi.a.16

Hu, A., Kozloff, V., Owen Van Horne, A., Chugani, D., & Qi, Z. (2023). Dissociation Between Linguistic and Nonlinguistic Statistical Learning in Children with Autism. *Journal of Autism and Developmental Disorders*, 1-16. DOI: 10.1007/s10803-023-05902-1

Schneider J.M., Hu A., Legault J., & Qi Z. (2020). Measuring statistical learning across modalities and domains in school-aged children via an online platform and neuroimaging techniques. *Journal of Visualized Experiments. e61474.* DOI: 10.3791/61474. [Video Protocol]

Schneider J.M., Weng Y-L., Hu A., & Qi Z. (2022). Linking the neural basis of distributional statistical learning with transitional statistical learning: The paradox of attention. *Neuropsychologia.* 172: 108284. DOI: 10.1016/j.neuropsychologia.2022.108284

Zinszer, B. D., Hannon, J., Hu, A., Kouadio, A. E., Akpé, H., Tanoh, F., Wang, M., Qi, Z., & Jasińska, K. (2024). Statistical learning and children's emergent literacy in rural Côte d'Ivoire. *Developmental Science*. https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1111/desc.13448

Zinszer, B. D., Hannon, J., Kouadio, É., Akpé, H., Tanoh, F., Hu, A., Qi, Z., & Jasińska, K. (2023). Does non-linguistic segmentation still predict literacy in an L2 education? Statistical learning in Ivorian primary schools. *Language Learning*. DOI: 10.1111/lang.12603.

Journal Papers Under Review

Hu, A., Parks, K., Schulz1, S., Larmer, S., Batterink, L., & Stevenson, R.A. (under review). Modality-Specific Consolidation Shapes Long-Term Retention in Statistical Learning. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/c73ws_v2

Hu A., Trice K., Lanka P., & Qi Z. (submitted). Plasticity of the Language Network Underpins Children's Greater Short-term Linguistic Learning Efficiency than Adults. https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/dprqe_v4.

Chege, M., Yang, F., Lovell, S., Hu, A., Stevenson, R.A. (submitted). Emotion Categorization Across Modalities: Representational Similarity and Clustering Patterns from Visual, Auditory, and Audiovisual Stimuli. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/rfyt4_v1.

Chege, M., Yang, F., Lovell, S., Al-Ramahi, N., Shiu, S., Hu, A., Stojanoski, B., Stevenson, R. (under review). Emotion Recognition Training Across Sensory Modalities: Comparing the Effects of Multisensory and Unisensory Training. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/65xzp_v1.

Conference Proceedings

(Peer-Reviewed)

Ning J., Hu A., Qi Z., & Sheng L. (2024). Novel word learning in multilingual children with and without autism spectrum disorder: roles of social cognition, multilingualism and vocabulary proficiency. In: L. K. Samuelson, S. L. Frank, M. Toneva, A. Mackey, & E. Hazeltine (Eds.), *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 46: 3829-3835. UC Merced eScholarship.

Hu A., Qi Z., & Franich K. (2023) Accommodation to vocal pitch in children with autism. In: Radek Skarnitzl & Jan Volín (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 20th International Congress of Phonetic Sciences.* 3912–3916. Guarant International.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND POSTERS

Oral Presentations

Hu, A., Fan, A., Mack, R., Kosich, K., Qi, Z., Stevenson, R. (*April, 2026*). "Vocabulary Acquisition in Noisy Social Contexts in Autistic Children". *International Society for Autism Research (INSAR)*. April 22-25, Prague. Accepted abstract.

Hu, A., Trice, K., Lanka, P., & Qi, Z. (November 2024). "The Changing Roles of the Language and Attention Systems in Statistical Learning Across Development". *The 49th Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD)*. November 7-10, Boston University.

Hu A., Trice K., Lanka P., & Qi Z. (June 2024). "Children are Better Linguistic Statistical Learner than Adults". *Interdisciplinary Advances in Statistical Learning*. San Sebastian, Spain.

Hu, A., Qi, Z., & Franich, K. (August 2023). "Accommodation to Vocal Pitch in Children with Autism". *International Congress of Phonetic Sciences*, Prague, Czech Republic.

Hu, A., & Qi, Z. (June 2023). "Selective Attention Facilitates Linguistic Statistical Learning in Autistic Children". *Annual Symposium on Research in Child Language Disorders (SRCLD)*, Madison, WI.

Hu, A., Trice, K., Weng, YL., & Qi, Z. (March 2023) "The Neurobiology of Auditory Statistical Learning is More Domain-Specific Early in Life". *Cognitive Neuroscience Society Annual Meeting (CNS)*, San Francisco, CA.

Hu, A., & Qi, Z. (March 2023). "Social Learning in School-Aged Children: The Effect of Social Contexts on Word Learning and Retention". Talk in Paper Symposium: "Observing, Conforming, and Internalizing: How Does Social Learning Occur Across Different Contexts and Cultures?" at *Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD)*, Salt Lake City, UT.

Hu, A., Kozloff, V., & Qi, Z. (March 2023) "Dissociation Between Linguistic and Nonlinguistic Statistical Learning in Children with Autism". *Meeting On Language in Autism (MoLA)*, Durham, NC.

Hu, A., Trice, K., Weng, YL., & Qi, Z. (November 2022). "Greater plasticity in the language network in children than adults during statistical learning". *The 47th Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD)*. November 3-6, Boston University.

Hu, A., & Qi, Z. (June 2022) "Dissociated learning processes in the development of statistical learning". *Interdisciplinary Advances in Statistical Learning*. San Sebastian, Spain.

Qi, Z., Hu, A., Legault, J., Weng, YL., Schneider, J., Kozloff, V., & Robbins, P. (July 2021). "Multimodal investigation of neural correlates of auditory statistical learning in children with ASD". *The International Association for the Study of Child Language (IASCL)*. Virtual.

Ionin, T., Choi, S., Hu, A., & Liu, Q. (September 2018) "Second language processing of definite articles in anaphoric and bridging contexts". *The 8th Meeting of Generative Approaches to Language Acquisition – North America (GALANA-8)*. September 28-30, Indiana University.

Posters

Hu A. & Qi Z. (March 2024). "Contributions of Vocabulary and Theory of Mind to Word Learning Across Social Contexts in Autistic Children". *Meeting On Language in Autism (MoLA)*, Durham, NC.

Hu A., Qi Z., Redmond S., & Franich K. (June 2023). "Accommodation to Vocal Pitch in Children with Autism". *Annual Symposium on Research in Child Language Disorders (SRCLD)*, Madison, WI.

Hu A. & Qi Z. (March 2023). "Word learning and retention from overhearing as a resilience factor for vocabulary acquisition in autistic children". *Meeting On Language in Autism (MoLA)*, Durham, NC.

Hu, A., Trice, K., Weng, YL., & Qi, Z. (October 2022). "Greater plasticity in the language network in children than adults during statistical learning". *Society for Neurobiology of Language (SNL)*, Philadelphia, USA.

Hu A., Kozloff, V., Owen Van Horne, A., & Qi, Z. (June 2022). "Disassociation between linguistic and nonlinguistic statistical learning in children with autism". *International Conference on Interdisciplinary Advances in Statistical Learning*, San Sebastian, Spain.

Hu, A., Kozloff, V., & Qi, Z. (April 2021) "Relationship between linguistic statistical learning and grammar development in children with autism spectrum disorder". *Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD)*. Virtual.

Hu, A., Kozloff, V., & Qi, Z. (November 2019) "Multimodal Statistical Learning in Children with Autism Spectrum Disorder". *The 44th Boston University Linguistics Conference on Language Development (BUCLD)*. November 7-10, Boston University.

Ovans Z., Ayala A., Asmah R., Hu A., Montoute M., Van Horne A., Qi Z., Morini G., & Huang Y.T. (2023). The feasibility of online (virtual-world) eye-tracking with young children. *Annual Human Sentence Processing Conference*, Pittsburgh, PA.

Lei, Y., Hu, A., Yan X., & Shih, C. (March 2019). "A Corpus-driven, Curriculum-based Approach to Assessing Less Commonly Taught Language in US Universities". *American Association for Applied Linguistics (AAAL)*. March 9-12, Atlanta, GA.

Mentored Undergraduate Oral Presentations

Siles B., Hu A., Montoute M., Chan K., Young-Hong S., & Qi Z. (2025). Auditory statistical learning predicts growth of phonological awareness in school-aged children: a summer reading intervention study. *New England Research on Dyslexia*, Charlestown, MA.

Siles, B., Hu, A., Chan, K., Ciriello, A., Christiansen, M. H., & Qi, Z. (2024). Validity of a gamified statistical learning task as a measure of children's real-world language

learning. *Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD)*. Boston, MA.

Mentored Undergraduate Posters

Cohen, E., Hu, A., & Qi, Z. (2023, April). Effects of social contexts on vocabulary development in children with autism. *Research Innovation Scholarship Entrepreneurship (RISE)*, Northeastern University, Boston, MA.

Foster, V., Hu, A., & Qi, Z. (2023, April). Impact of social context and facial cues on adult word learning. *Research Innovation Scholarship Entrepreneurship (RISE)*, Northeastern University, Boston, MA.

Voso, L., Pradyumna, L., Trice, K., Hu, A., Legault, J., & Qi, Z. (2023, April). Neuroanatomical Development of the Human Language System. *Research Innovation Scholarship Entrepreneurship (RISE)*, Northeastern University, Boston, MA.

Rios, D., Kozloff, V., Robbins, P., Hu, A., & Qi, Z. (2019, April). Effects of social contexts on vocabulary development in children with autism [Conference presentation]. *Undergraduate Research Symposium*, University of Delaware, Newark, DE.

RESEARCH PROJECTS & EXPERIENCE

Multisensory Pathways in Children's Language Learning

- *Social learning*: Study how face visibility and auditory noise affect word learning in neurotypical and neurodivergent children
- *Implicit learning*: Test whether music entrainment enhances children's implicit statistical learning using behavioral and EEG measures
- *Developmental pathways*: Investigate cascading relationships among multisensory integration, social cognition, and language learning across development

Implicit Learning and Language Development

Project 1: The Changing Roles of the Language and Attention Systems in Statistical Learning Across Development

- Led five behavioral and fMRI studies on statistical learning (SL) across 300 neurotypical adults and neurodiverse children (submitted paper)
- Identified statistical learning as a potential predictor of language development in autistic children and children with reading difficulties (published paper)

- Demonstrated that domain-general attention can enhance SL in children with language difficulties (dissertation)

Project 2: Speech Adaptation in School-aged Autistic Children

- Showed atypical pitch adaption in autistic children by comparing pitch entrainment to model talkers in sentence repetition tasks (published proceeding)
- Developed and launched open-source web-based audio recording software for at-home speech data collection (github repository)

Social Learning and Vocabulary Acquisition

Project 3: Incidental Word Learning Across Social Contexts in Children

- Uncovered overhearing as a resilenece factor to word learning and retention in school-aged autistic children (poster)
- Executed a 3-year production process for naturalistic story stimuli, encompassing script development, filming, editing video and audio materials

Project 4: Quality of Web-based Eye Tracking Experiments in Children

- Partnered with 4 labs across institutes to analyze web-based eye tracking data, assessing its quality in child developmental research (published paper)
- Engineered a Python script for eyegaze coding, enhancing efficiency by 50% (github)

LABORATORY EXPERIENCE

Sensory Perception Lab, *Western University* 2024 - Present
Postdoctoral Associate, Advisor: Ryan Stevenson

- Mentored 3 undergraduate students throughout the full research project lifecycle
- Initiated collaborations with three labs spanning sensory, reading, clinical research

Language Acquisition and Brain Lab, *UDEL & Northeastern University* 2018 - 2024
Graduate Student Researcher, Advisor: Zhenghan Qi

- Directed training in transcription, eye-tracking coding, and experiment administration
- Engineered gaming platforms and audio recording tools for open-science research

Language Acquisition Lab, *UIUC* 2017 - 2018
Undergraduate Research Assistant, Advisor: Cynthia Fisher

- Collected and coded eye tracking data in word learning studies with toddlers

Electrophysiology and Language Processing Lab, *UIUC* 2017 - 2018
Undergraduate Research Assistant, Advisor: Darren Tanner

- Administered event-related potentials (ERP), eye-tracking, and speech production studies on sentence processing in adult second language learners

Second Language Acquisition and Bilingualism Lab, *UIUC* 2016 - 2018

Undergraduate Research Assistant, Advisor: Tania Ionin

- Constructed Mandarin stimuli and led studies on object-substance recognition related to classifier use in Korean and Chinese speakers.

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

ADOS-2 Clinical Workshop
Washington, DC, July 11-12, 2019

Training on Neural Synchronization and Hyperscanning Techniques
State Key Laboratory of Cognitive Neuroscience and Learning, Beijing Normal University, China, June 2019

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Graduate Student Colloquium Committee, *UDEL* 2018 – 2022

- Organized monthly colloquiums, hosting scholars from leading universities for two-day departmental visits

Experimental Group Meeting Committee, *UDEL* 2018 –2020

- Coordinated weekly intra-departmental student meetings on experimental research

Division of General Studies Leaders, *UIUC* 2016 –2018

- Acted as an advisory board member to the DGS Director, offering monthly feedback and recommendations for the College of General Studies

LANGUAGES

English: Native-like
Cantonese/ Mandarin: Native Language
Korean: Fluent Listener and Speaker
Japanese: Proficient Listener

COMPUTER SKILLS

Programming: R (advanced), Git (advanced), Java Script (intermediate), Python (intermediate), Shell (intermediate), HTML (intermediate), CSS (intermediate), Matlab (novice)
Platforms and Frameworks: Gorilla Experiment Builder, Bluehost, Qualtrics, Github, jsPsych, Node.js,
Software: Docker, Adobe Premiere Pro, Praat, Audition, Microsoft Office